BIRTHS, MARRIAGES, AND DEATHS.

BIRTHS.

EXHAM—On the 3rd ult., at Lucknow, the wife of Richard Exham, Esq., Surgeon-Major A.M.D., of a daughter.

LORAINE—On the 3rd inst., at Garrioch Hall, Glasgow, the wife of Major Loraine, R.A., of a daughter.

HENDIN—On the 4th inst., at Cedar-road, Bevois Mount, Southampton, the wife of Mr. T. Hendin, of a daughter.

HILL—On the 5th inst., at Tarvet House, Carlton-crescent, Southampton, the wife of W. Burrough Hill, of a daughter.

MARRIAGES.

MAJOR—WALLACE—On the 5th inst., at St. John's Free Church of England, Southampton, by the Rev. E. J. Boon, G. Major to E. Wallace, both of Southampton.

LANHAM—DOMONEY—On the 6th inst., at St. John's Free Church of England, Southampton, by the Rev. E. J. Boon, William Thomas Lanham to Rose Domoney.

WEIGHT—ROSE—On the 6th inst., at St. John's Free Church of England, Southampton, by the Rev. E. J. Boon, Henry Weight to Alice Sarah Rose.

DEATHS.

CONNELY—On the 3rd inst., at Jersey-road, Buckland, Charles Newton, son of Mr. Michael Connely, aged two years.

MITCHELL—On the 4th inst., at Bedford-street, Brighton, Mr. John Mitchell, aged 31 years.

HATFIELD—On the 4th inst., at Gladstone-street, Landport, William Charles, son of Mr. George Hatfield, aged two years.

BUCKTON—On the 5th inst., at Wellington-row, Landport, Mr. Thomas Buckton, aged 43 years.

FRYER—On the 6th inst., at Alexander-terrace, Landport, Mr. James Richard Fryer, aged 43 years.

VICK—On the 7th inst., at 110, High-street, Portsmouth, Emma Frances, daughter of G. W. Vick, outfitter, aged 32 years.

MITCHELL—On the 7th inst., at 2, Queen's-road, Gosport, Ann, second daughter of the late Major Thomas Mitchell, Royal Marines.

PERHAM—On the 7th inst., at Southsea, Francis Burden Perham, Assistant-Engineer R.N., aged 27 years.

AT the Portsea Island Union Workhouse: Charlotte Smith, aged 77 years; George Stevens, 31.

THIS EVENING'S ANNOUNCEMENTS.

THEATRE ROYAL, Landport—Messrs. Holt and Wilmott's "Taken from Life" Company, at 7.30.

PORTLAND HALL, Southsea — "Olivette" Comic Opera, at 8.

THE AMPHITHEATRE, Gunwharf-road, and St. Mary's-street, Portsmouth—Variety Entertainment, at 7.30.

SOUTHSEA CLARENCE ESPLANADE PIER — Promenade Concerts, from 4 till 6 and 7.30 till 9.30.

WEATHER FORECASTS.

The following is a statement of the weather that will probably be experienced for the 24 hours from and after 11 a.m. to-day:—

DISTRICTS.	FORECASTS.
0. Scotland, N. ... / 1. Scotland, E. ...	Moderate N.W. to W. winds; fair to unsettled and some rain.
2. England, E. .. / 3. England, E. .. / 4. Mid Counties / 5. England, S. (London and Channel). ..	Moderate winds; fair generally and warmer.
6. Scotland, W.	Same as Nos. 0 and 1.
7. England, N.W. (and N. Wales).	Moderate or fresh W. winds; fair on the whole, but not settled.
8. England, S.W. (and S. Wales).	Same as No. 5.
9. Ireland, N. ..	Same as Nos. 0 and 1.
10. Ireland, S. ..	Moderate or fresh W. winds; fair to cloudy and some rain.

WARNINGS:—None issued.

In Portsmouth, at 11 o'clock, this morning the indications were:—

BAR.	THERM.	WIND.	WEATHER.
29·90 Rising.	64°	Moderate W. breezes.	Cloudy.

HIGH WATER.

PORTSMOUTH HARBOUR.

	a.m.	p.m.		a.m.	p.m.
To-day........	4.14	4.38	To-morrow ..	5.5	5.37

At Spithead, at full and change, the eastern stream makes about two o'clock, 2½ hours after high water in the harbour, and runs seven hours S.E. by S.; and the western stream about nine o'clock, 2½ hours before high water in the harbour, and runs five hours N.W. by N.

The Evening News.

SATURDAY, AUGUST 11TH, 1883.

THE STRIKE OF THE PORTSMOUTH STAY OPERATIVES.

THE sympathy of the public of Portsmouth has ranged itself strongly on the side of the factory girls, who have resigned their employment rather than submit to what they consider an unreasonable, and consequently an unjust, demand on the part of their employers. That workpeople should be taxed in order to reimburse an employer the cost which he thinks fit to incur in using steam as the motive power of his factory is, to say the least of it, a startling innovation, and it certainly is not surprising that the attempt should have been resisted by girls whose pay during considerable portions of the year, we are now told, is barely sufficient to keep body and soul together. Furthermore, the method in which this tax is levied is as unjust as the principle of the thing appears to be vicious. That it is a tax and not merely a charge for an article—viz., motive power—supplied, is proved by the method of its incidence. By the system which the employers are seeking to enforce, a factory owner employing an average of 300 indoor hands, would wring from them the enormous sum of £15 per week on the shallow pretence of making his hands contribute towards the cost of the steam that drove their machines, whereas all users of steam will know full well that such a charge would yield a profit of at least a hundred per cent. to the person by whom it was imposed and the money collected. The excuse by which the employers are now seeking to justify this most unpopular revival of what seems once to have been a custom of this peculiar trade is that the indoor workers are otherwise placed at a considerable advantage over those who do the work at their own homes, but the advantage to the manufacturer of having the work done upon his own premises by people who, throughout the whole process, are under the eyes of his overseers, is so great and so tangible as to far and away overbalance the petty deduction of the shilling per week which it is now attempted to extort. The indoor girl certainly has the advantage of working with her employer's machine, and of being freed from the labour, such as it is, of driving the treadle with her foot; but then again she is, it seems, required to pay for the needles she uses and also for the springs of her machine, and the loss of her independence is a commodity that assuredly should be taken into account in estimating her position in contrast with that of her out-door competitor. Still more may, however, be said against the method in which it is proposed to levy this tax than against the principle. The girls are invariably employed at piece work—so much per dozen stays being paid to them in lieu of wages; thus it is evident that they must earn very variable sums, and that consequently some of them must derive a far greater benefit from the steam than their slower or less efficient comrades—thus then, as we have already said, the proposal to charge them, all round, an arbitrary shilling per week is manifestly unjust—how unjust it is may be gleaned from the fact that we are assured that when work is slack, some of the hands earn no more than two or three shillings for their week's work. Supposing then for the sake of argument, that the novel and startling proposal that has led to the strike is capable of justification, it is clear that in common justice, the deductions can only be legitimately made in the same proportion as the girls are paid.

THE LAST OF THE DYNAMITE CONSPIRACIES.

Two more crushing blows have just been administered at Liverpool to that rapidly becoming extinct class of Irish or American Irish agitators who seek to gain their chimerical ends by the use of destructive force, levelled in secret at the lives and property of people whom they have never seen, and whose removal would no more further their objects than would an attempt to bale out the sea. It was clear from the first that the four conspirators charged before Mr. Justice Stephen would have but little chance of an acquittal in view of the strong array of facts against them. In the possession of one an infernal machine was found, together with documents that revealed the whole fiendish conspiracy, and, what was still better, enabled the police to apprehend the other agents in it. Then with the example set by the trials of Whitehead and Co. in London, it was easy to forecast the result, and therefore the sentence of penal servitude for life was received more with a feeling of relief than of surprise. The most satisfactory thing about these dynamite conspiracies has been their utter harmlessness to the public, while as to those who organised them, most of whom are doomed to life-long captivity, they must indeed have found the game not worth the candle. The other blow struck was at the fanatic O'Brien, who thought to subvert the ends of justice by libelling its administration, but he also is probably convinced by this time how very puny and futile his efforts have been.

DR. MOFFAT.

IT was not without a painful feeling of regret that the public learnt yesterday of the death of the veteran missionary and traveller Dr. Robert Moffat. He has gone down to his grave full of years and honours, and Scotland at least will raise a tribute to his memory. His life had been one long effort for the enlightenment of the heathen, and he was successful beyond ordinary men. When only 22 years of age, he undertook the, at that time, exceedingly perilous task of going among the South African savages who lived beyond the borders of the Cape Colony. But he went fearlessly and trustfully, and as the result showed successfully. Wherever he went, the gospel lamp was lit and is still burning, and the arts of civilisation were in many cases substituted for savage barbarities. With but few interruptions, he was engaged for no less than 53 years in South Africa, but at length he was compelled by the exigencies of nature to leave the scene of his labours to younger men and return to England. Beyond his work for Christianity, he did good service in other fields as an explorer and a naturalist, his work on his travels and adventures being one of the best we have, describing life and scenery in those, even yet, little known regions. In 1873 he was publicly presented with a sum of £5,800, in recognition of his great services, and since then he has been quietly descending the vale of life in a quiet Kentish home. A proposal will probably be made that his remains should be interred with those of our other illustrious dead, and the country would applaud such a well-merited tribute.

NEWS OF THE DAY.

THE Hecla, torpedo vessel, got under weigh from Spithead this morning for torpedo practice.

THE Dwarf, 4, screw gun vessel, Lieutenant-Commander W. J. Moore, arrived in Portsmouth Harbour this morning from the westward.

THE Enchantress, Admiralty yacht, Staff-Commander E. H. Hills, which was to have sailed to-morrow morning for Havre, will not leave until the following day.

IT is officially announced that the statement that Vice-Admiral Lord John Hay intended to leave Patras on the 21st inst., and reach Zante on the 26th is incorrect.

HER Majesty's ship Satellite, 8, Captain C. B. Theobald, arrived at Monte Video on Thursday, on her way to the Pacific Station, for which she will leave on the 15th inst.

FOUND DEAD IN BED.—Charlotte White, of 5, Waterloo-place, Landport, was found dead in bed at that address at 3.30 p.m. yesterday. An inquest will be held on Monday.

THE Lords of the Admiralty have devoted an additional £15,000 to the sum for Portsmouth Yard for the purpose of increasing the armoured tonnage to be built during the year.

HER Majesty's ship Sheldrake, 4, Lieut.-Commander Marcus L. Bridger, which was recommissioned at Hong Kong in June, 1879, and which has been ordered to return home to be paid off, arrived at Aden on Thursday homeward bound.

ATTEMPTED ESCAPE OF A CONVICT.—Yesterday a convict broke away from the gang in which he was at work in Portsmouth Dockyard, but he was, however, quickly missed and captured. When found he was almost naked and had evidently been in the mud.

ACCIDENT.—A boy named Barnes, living at Ranwell's-court, St. George's-square, Portsea, was accidentally knocked down and run over by a horse and van in Commercial-road. The vehicle was in charge of George Hunt, of Sussex-street, Southsea, who conveyed the boy to the hospital, where on examination it was found that no bones were broken, and Barnes was detained for treatment.

THE CRIMEAN MEMORIALS. — General Conolly, formerly Military Attaché to the Embassy at Paris, has just passed through Paris, *en route* for the Crimea, where he has undertaken to superintend the putting into a decent and fit state of the memorials to the Englishmen who fell in the war. He will be assisted in this work by the British Consul at Sebastopol.

THE 1ST HANTS ARTILLERY VOLUNTEERS. — This morning, by the 9.5 train, 50 men of the above regiment, under the command of Captain Reynolds, were entrained *en route* for Shoeburyness to take part in the competition for Artillery Volunteers during the ensuing week. The men looked very smart in heavy marching order, with their great coats strapped to their backs, haversacks, water bottles, etc. We sincerely hope they may be as fortunate as last year, when they had the distinguished honour of winning the Duke of Cambridge's Cup.

MASONIC.—Yesterday afternoon the Provincial Grand Lodge of Hampshire assembled in the Corn Exchange, Petersfield, when the chair was occupied by Mr. W. W. B. Beach, M.P., R.W. Prov. Grand Master. The lodge business having been transacted, the Grand Master elected and invested his grand officers for the ensuing year as follows:—Messrs. W. Hickman, 130, D.G.M.; Mark E. Frost, 487, S.G.W.; H. Martin Green, 1958, J.G.W.; the Rev. P. G. Pickering, 35, and the Rev. A. L'Argent Bell, 394, G.C.; Michael Emanuel, 359, G.R.; J. E. Le Feuvre, 130, G.S.; R. J. Rastrick, 1069, G.T.; J. S. Hickley, 723, S.G.D.; G. M. Burt, 551, J.G.D.; W. B. Edgeler, 928, G.S.Wks.; J. S. Pearce, 1780, G.D.C.; Henry Croucher, 342, G.A.D.C.; J. Woodhouse, 928, G.S.B.; Francis Powell, 903, G.P.; A. J. Firth, 1869, G.O.; Robertson, 130, Bosoman, 1461, and Cheshire, 1331, G.St. Mr. Hickman, deputy grand master, was unfortunately prevented, through illness, from attending. A magnificent copy of the Holy Bible, dated 1613, in an excellent state of preservation was presented by Mr. Michael Emanuel to the Provincial Grand Lodge. The book had a splendid gold plate on the cover bearing a suitable inscription. At the conclusion of the business, the brethren adjourned to the Dolphin Hotel, where a most *recherche* banquet was served.

THE STAY STRIKE.

Mr. Leetham Reynolds has requested us to state that many of the statements made by correspondents in writing on the causes of the strike are inaccurate. He affirms that the use of steam enables the workers to do considerably more than they would be able to if the treadle only were used, but he says that owing to the dilatoriness of many of the girls, a far larger number of hands have to be employed than would otherwise be necessary. As justifying the charge for the steam, he declares that its use wears out the machines, and that the charge of a shilling includes the keeping of the machines in order. It is absolutely untrue, he says, that 1s. 6d. has been taken off the price paid for certain kinds of work, the utmost ever deducted being from 3d. to 6d., and that only on a low class of goods made by inexperienced hands. It is likewise untrue, he says, that girls are ever fined for looking out of the window. Furthermore, he states that whenever a girl is absent on leave or through sickness, a proportion of the shilling charge is remitted. A point in favour of the indoor workers is that in slack time the indoor hands have the preference. For many years, he says, there have not been more than two or three weeks in any one season in which the hands have had so little as half time.—Our reporters have ascertained that the majority of the hands have returned to work at the Grosvenor-street factory, in consequence of some of the prices having been raised to what they were a few weeks ago. The premises continue to be guarded by police, but there has been no attempt to-day to renew the disturbance. Several of the hands have expressed a desire to return, but Saturday being a short day they will not be taken on until Monday. We have received the following letters on the subject.:—

SIR,—Having seen in your issue of the 8th inst. that the home workers received only the same rate of pay as the factory hands, while they did not enjoy the advantages of steam, I should like to draw your attention to the fact that while the factory hands are depending on their pay for their subsistence it is usually an additional source of income to the home workers, who are mostly married women. Apologising for trespassing on your space,

I remain, your obedient servant,

A FACTORY HAND.

SIR,—Will you kindly allow us a space in your valuable paper concerning our factory strike, and to express the hope that the tradespeople of Portsmouth will kindly support us in our strike. We should like to know who and what it is that supports our employers and the town at large but us, and our hard work; and we think it very cruel that they are not satisfied with cutting down the prices of our work, but that they want to charge us a shilling each out of our small earnings for the steam of their factories, which leaves the girls barely enough money for the dry bread they eat.

We are, Sir, yours respectfully,

TWO MACHINE HANDS.

SIR,—Will you kindly allow me—one of the factory girls—a space in your valuable paper. I, for one, will never pay for steam while they pay so bad for my work. After stock-taking last May—when we went into work again—there was as much as a shilling taken off from some work and sixpence off other kinds. As for Mr. Woodman saying 5s. a week is enough to keep a girl on, he ought to try it. If I had my will, I would keep him on bread and water, and let him see how he would like to be kept on 5s. a week. He is a Liberal, I know. Trusting the girls will not give in and hoping we shall have justice done to us,

I remain, Yours respectfully,

A MACHINIST THAT WON'T PAY FOR STEAM.

PORTSMOUTH POLICE COURT.

THIS DAY.

Before Captain McCoy and E. M. Wells, Esq.

ROBBING HIS FATHER.—Walter Fairclough Barrow, 21, was charged with stealing a watch, pipe, and cigar holder, the property of his father, and was remanded until Thursday as all the property had not been recovered.

TRAGEDY AT LUGANO.

A tragic incident has just spread consternation amongst the tourists who frequent this part. Count Dolfini, of Padua, has lately come with his wife to reside in the picturesque little village of Melida, on the borders of the lake. They stayed at the Hotel Castelli, where they lived in great state. A night or two since the count approached M. Castelli, and without any warning fired twice at him with a revolver, wounding him mortally. The count then fled, but was pursued and arrested. He has since ineffectually attempted suicide.

AN ISLAND DESTROYED BY A VOLCANO.

A communication received from Panama, dated July 19th, gives details of an immense volcanic outbreak at Ometepec, an island on Lake Nicaragua. For the past three months a quiescent volcano has given signs that it was about to burst into activity. The inhabitants of the island have been frightened, and for leagues round on the mainland the people have been kept in constant excitement. On June 19th, the lava streamed from the new crater and ran in the direction of Las Pilas. The sides of the mountain became alive with fire as the lava poured down, sweeping with it trees, rocks, and earth, whilst the continued bellowings and roarings brought terror to all who heard them. For several days the whole island was continually quaking. Many inhabitants fled, and the authorities commenced the removal of every one from the island. On the 24th the lava bed had covered up the road, and two young men were buried under it. The molten matter continued to pour out in an almost uninterrupted stream. A panic set in among the populace, and schooners and boats were sent to the island to transport the people to Granada, Rivas, and other cities. The lava flow on the 25th took a new direction, and cut off communication with the farms and pastures upon which the islanders depend for their living. The eruptions became terrible in their intensity, and led to the few remaining people fleeing to the mainland. Boiling lava, mud, ashes, and rocks, now cover the sides of the mountain and the pleasant slopes which have been cultivated for centuries.

THE LATE CAPTAIN WEBB.

A meeting, attended by about a dozen professional and amateur swimmers, was held last evening at Anderton's Hotel, Fleet-street, for the purpose of devising means to perpetuate the memory of the late Captain Webb. At first it was suggested that a fund should be raised, one half to be devoted to the erection of a suitable monument at Dawley Magna, Capt. Webb's native place in Shropshire, and the other half given to his widow and children. It was then pointed out that three separate subscriptions had already been commenced, and that it would be out of place to interfere with these; and it was accordingly resolved that for the present the only course taken should be to hold an entertainment at the Lambeth Baths.

The accounts furnished by the American papers of the finding of Captain Webb's body supplement the cabled particulars. The body was found floating down with the current about two rods from the American shore. The face was downwards, as if he had died while swimming. The body was brought ashore at Lewiston, and five hundred persons came down from the Falls to see it. Many of these five hundred knew the Captain's features well, and could identify the remains. Mrs. Webb when first she saw the body did not recognise the face. It was sadly altered by the violence of the struggle. When Mrs. Webb was assured of the identity she uttered an agonising cry, and had to be carried from the place. At the inquest Mrs. Webb was present, and then simply gave evidence of identification. A medical man, who had made a *post-mortem* examination, said he thought the reactionary force of the water had paralysed the nerve centres, and rendered breathing impossible. The jury found an open verdict, adding that they were unable to determine the immediate cause of death.

THE BOOTLE TOWN CLERKSHIP.

At a meeting of the Bootle Town Council last night, it was resolved to advertise for a new Town Clerk, in place of Colonel Pierce, the defaulter, at a salary of £500. It was stated that Pierce had not been found. A question was raised as to the liability of the Corporation to the bondholders, but it was stated that that would be a legal question for decision, and it would have to be fought out.

TREASURE-TROVE IN POLAND.

A large quantity of rare silver coins has been lately found at Borecice, in the Krotoczin districts in Prussian Poland. A farmer was having a large stone removed from one of his fields, and the workmen found deep beside it an urn with 530 silver coins of Bohemian, German, Hungarian, and even Anglo-Saxon mintage. With them were some silver ornaments and a few silver bars. They were all taken to the Royal Museum of Coins at Berlin.

FATAL TRICYCLE ACCI[illegible]T.

Yesterday a lad named Willia[illegible] [illegible]therton, the son of a blacksmith, was rid[illegible] a tricycle along the side of the River Kennet, Reading, when the wheel of the machine knocked against a post, the effect being to cause the tricycle to swerve round to the water's edge. The boy fell backwards into the Kennet, the machine falling upon the top of him. He was a good swimmer, but being unable to disengage himself from the weight of the tricycle, was drowned.

MAD FREAK OF A WOMAN.

Yesterday afternoon Robina Chambers, 19, tenant of a top flat in 7, Falshaw-street, Leith-walk, Edinburgh, fell from a front window to the pavement, about 40 feet beneath, fracturing her skull. She was conveyed to Leith Hospital, where she lies in an unconscious state, and is not expected to survive. It is stated that in the morning Chambers exhibited jealousy of another young woman, and that while under the influence of liquor she jumped out of the window.

TEMPERANCE LEGISLATION IN THE ORANGE FREE STATE.

The Orange Free State Road have recently passed a law by which it is enacted that "no license will in future be granted outside a town, village, or diggings under Government control; no strong drink whatsoever to be sold or given to any native except by his own master; no minor may be supplied with drink; no general dealer can obtain a liquor license or be allowed to keep any intoxicants on his premises, not even for the purpose of offering a customer. the usual 'introductory soepje' previous to transaction.

A SUPPOSED FENIAN.

At Aston, Birmingham, Police-court yesterday, Frederick Malone, middle aged, described as a tailor, of no fixed residence, was charged with stealing a man's cloth coat of the value of 2s. 6d. Mr. Superintendent Hinde said that the documents found in the prisoner's possession connected him with various organisations, both in Lancashire and in London, and as it was believed he had been previously convicted, he wished the Bench to grant a remand so as to enable the police to communicate with the authorities in London. The Bench granted the application.

NOVEL SYSTEM OF RAILWAY COMPETITION.

A novel system of competition has been started in the United States by the Pennsylvania Railway Company, which is one of the principal lines between Chicago and New York. Recently the company has advertised its through time at between one and two hours shorter than the time taken by the New York Central or the Erie roads, agreeing with passengers that if the train between Chicago and New York should be half-an-hour behind time, each passenger will be entitled to a return of $5.

VEGETARIAN CHEESE.

Earnest vegetarians who do not repudiate cheese have been seriously troubled by the necessity of using the stomachs of slaughtered calves as a source of the rennet which is used in making the curd, and many attempts to supersede the animal coagulant by using vegetable and mineral acids, alum, &c., have failed. Sir William Hooker, however, states that a shrub common in Northern India supplies a vegetable rennet. Its name is the *Puneeria coagulans.* A decoction of 30 parts of its powdered capsules in 1,150 parts of water is a coagulating liquid of such a strength that a teaspoonful is sufficient for curdling a gallon of milk, or otherwise stated, the quantity required is one teaspoonful of the powder to 38 gallons of milk.

The steamship Camoens is carrying some 600 emigrants from Iceland to America.

Chinese missionaries to the number of 231 have petitioned the House of Commons against the opium traffic.

A marriage has been arranged between Gladys, Countess of Lonsdale, and Mr. Lud E. White, eldest son of Lord Annaly.

At Oldham on Thursday a summons for libel against the *Oldham Standard* was issued. The proceedings are taken by Dr. Graham, of Middleton.

The Leeds School Board has arranged with the Yorkshire Penny Bank for the establishment of transfer banks at all the Board Schools.

It is in contemplation to organise an influential committee of noblemen and gentlemen in order to raise subscriptions for the sufferers by the late earthquake at Ischia.

The bodies of two of the three children drowned on Thursday at Castleford by the upsetting of a boat, have been recovered. Two children who narrowly escaped are doing very well.

The "Clarke Buildings" additions to Trinity College, Melbourne University, which have been almost entirely built by Sir William and Mr. Joseph Clarke at a cost of £11,000 have been completed.

The great Irish National demonstration which was to have been held on Mr. Parnell's Avondale estate on Sunday has been abandoned in consequence, it is said, of an intimation from the authorities that the meeting would be suppressed.

The Postmaster-General has issued a circular acknowledging the very zealous and efficient manner in which all ranks of the service has discharged arduous duties devolving upon them in connection with the introduction of the Parcel Post.

The Board of Trade returns of emigration issued on Thursday show that the total number of persons who left the United Kingdom for places out of Europe during the month of July was 33,003, as compared with 32,330 in July of last year.

One hundred and fourteen members of Parliament have joined the London Municipal Reform League. Among the Peers who have become members of the League are the Earl of Dalhousie, Earl Powerscourt, and the Earl of St. Germains.

Dingley Hall estate, in Northamptonshire, was sold to Viscount Downe yesterday for £90,000. It contains 1,545 acres, and yields a rental of £2,750 a year. It includes the rights of six manors and the perpetual presentation to the rectory of Dingley.

The Paris Political Economy Society has been discussing the advisability of introducing the Torrens Land Act, now in operation in Australia, into France. In the course of the discussion it was stated that the land in France is broken up into 125,000,000 plots.

Wednesday's storm proved, as was expected, most disastrous to the Scotch herring fleet. In addition to the loss of a Wick boat and six lives, a fisherman was drowned from a Montrose boat, and a Johnshaven boat and crew are missing. Out of 600 boats which left Peterhead on Wednesday, only 550 are reported. Yesterday the gale broke out with renewed violence.

THE MURDER OF FIVE CHILDREN.

THE INQUEST.

STATEMENT BY THE PRISONER.

Mr. C. C. Lewis, the coroner for the southern division of Essex, held an inquest yesterday afternoon at the Board room of the Walthamstow Cemetery, on the bodies of the five children—Charles, aged 3½ years; Herbert, aged 2½ years; and Frederick, aged sixteen months, who were drowned; and two infant boys, aged seven days, unnamed, who were struck on the head with a hammer and killed by their father, William Gouldstone, on Wednesday night last. The first witness called was Ada Hamilton, of 8, Courtenay-place, St. James's-street, Walthamstow, the wife of a jeweller, who said:—I have been with my husband living in the house three weeks. I had been engaged to attend Mrs. Gouldstone in her confinement as nurse. She was attended by a medical man, and was confined on August 1st. She was delivered of twins, two boys. All went on well till last Wednesday night. Gouldstone frequently saw his wife after her confinement. He went to see her every night when he came home from work. He had never, however, asked to look at the newly-born boys. He slept in the kitchen. Last Wednesday night he returned home at about a quarter past five o'clock. Mr. Gouldstone came into the bedroom and stood by the bedside of his wife, but he never spoke. His wife said to him, "How is it you are so early home to-night?" He said, "I left when the manager went for his dinner." He worked at 67, Upper Thames-street. She then asked, "Have you told them at the shop that I have been confined?" She meant the workshop. He replied, "No." She had at this time her little boy Freddy, 16 months old, on the bed at the foot, and Gouldstone picked it up and took it into the kitchen. By that time I had finished washing and dressing the first baby, and had laid it down by its mother's side. I had occasion to go out into the kitchen, and saw all the three children playing on the floor there, the father sitting on the fireguard. I returned to the bedroom, and said to Mrs. Gouldstone, "Now, I'll make your bed if you get out." I got Mrs. Gouldstone out of bed, and I put her back again. I then asked Gouldstone if I should go out of the room, but he did not answer. I went downstairs, leaving Mrs. Gouldstone with her two infants by her side. When I reached the yard door I heard cries of "Murder!" and I recognised Mrs. Gouldstone's voice. I ran upstairs and tried to open the bedroom door, but it was locked on the inside. She said, "Open the door, he is murdering my children." I tried to force the door, but could not. I called "Help," and Mrs. Clarke (the landlady of the house) came running upstairs, and we both tried to force the door. Gouldstone opened the door. I said, "Oh, you wicked man; what have you done?" I had not then seen anything done to the children. Mrs. Gouldstone was at the foot of the bedstead. She said, "Come and look at my babies, and see if he has killed them." I passed into the room, and saw the two babies on a pillow behind her—she was down at the foot—where I had laid them. They were each bleeding from the nose and the mouth, and one of them had a bruise right over one of its eyes. They were both breathing. When I said "Oh, you wicked man," he said "No, I am not a wicked man; I am a happy man." I passed in and stood by Mrs. Gouldstone's side. She told me that he had murdered the other three children, and she asked me to go and see aftr them. I had no previous idea that they were dead. As I entered the kitchen door I saw Gouldstone bringing little Frederick in his arms from the scullery. His clothes were wringing wet. I put my head out of the door, and saw a policeman standing in the kitchen. Gouldstone and the constable went into Mrs. Gouldstone's bedroom. She said, "Will you give me all the money you have? I have my doctor to pay;" and he gave her all he had in his pocket. He then kissed her, and said "Good-bye," and the constable then removed him from the house.—William Cheeseman, police constable, 26 N, stationed at Lea Bridge-road, who took the prisoner into custody, said: On going to the house I saw William Gouldstone in the kitchen. He was in a stooping position over three children lying side by side on the floor. The three children appeared to be dead, and were thoroughly drenched with water. Gouldstone had his coat and hat off, and his shirt-sleeves tucked up. As soon as he saw me he came towards the door and said "Good evening, policeman. I have done it; now I am happy. I am ready for the rope." I cautioned him that whatever he said would be used in evidence against him. He then put on his coat and hat, and said, "Let me see my wife." I took him into the bed room, and his wife said, "Oh, you wicked man, what have you done?" He said, "I have killed all your children. Now you'll be single again, and I shall be hanged." His wife said, "Have you any money?" He said, "Yes," and gave her all he had. He then kissed her and bade her "Good-bye." On the way to the police-station he said, "When I took my money last week I thought of buying a revolver to do it with, but I altered my mind, as I thought it would make too much noise. I had a hard job with the two eldest, but the other little one—I soon settled him. I thought it was too hot. I have had five children in about three years and a half, so I thought I would put a stop to it." At the police station he said "I've done it like a man," and when he was charged—the charge being read over to him by the inspector—with having murdered the five children, he said, "Quite right, sir." The inquiry was then adjourned.

Mr. Alfred Tennyson has had a private interview with her Majesty at Osborne.

A Lloyd's telegram, dated Malta, August 9, says:—"Her Majesty's ship Eclipse has left here for England."

The Anchor Line steamer City of Rome has arrived at New York after a remarkable run of seven days two hours.

Harvest on the Royal Farm at Windsor was commenced yesterday, when wheat cutting took place on the Prince Consort's farm. The crop is in splendid condition.

Five provisional battalions of Volunteers, numbering nearly 4,000 men, will arrive at Aldershot to-day, for eight days' training with the Regular troops.

Fresh riots occurred at Alexandria last night. A large number of armed natives attempted to destroy the ambulances, but were dispersed by the police without difficulty.

At Whittingham asylum, near Manchester, a lunatic named Macdonald, whilst at dinner, got a piece of beef two inches long in his wind-pipe, and was choked to death.

It is stated that damage was done in the anti-Jewish riots in Pesth to the amount of 12,000 florins. Great complaint is made of the police for not taking measures to prevent the disorders.

Lieutenant-Colonel Broughton (Plymouth Division) R.M.L.I., will be detached to the depôt, Walmer, for duty, to replace Lieut.-Colonel Walsh, appointed assistant-adjutant-general, Royal Marines.

A milk contractor named Byrne, who lives in Barrack-street Dublin, and supplies the garrison, was prosecuted yesterday before Mr. Woodlock, police magistrate, for selling milk adulterated with water. He was sentenced to pay a fine of £20.

A severe thunderstorm prevailed at South Shields yesterday afternoon. The ss. Mayfield, from Montrose, arrived in the Tyne, having been in collision off Coquet Island with the sailing vessel Xantao, which lost bowsprit and had stern damaged.

Orders have been given in Paris to send some additional troops to Madagascar, but it is stated that there is no intention to advance beyond Tamatave, and that the reinforcements are merely to enable the French to keep the Hovas at a sufficient distance.

The portraits on the new postage stamps that come in use in America October 1st are:—1-cent, Franklin; 2-cent, Jackson; 3-cent, Washington; 5-cent, Garfield; 6-cent, Lincoln; 7-cent, Stanton; 10-cent, Jefferson; 12-cent, Clay; 15-cent, Scott; 30-cent, Hamilton; 90-cent, Perry.

THE DEAD SEA CANAL.

The irreverence of the times is perfectly shocking. The coolness with which the promoters of the alternative canal which is to make M. de Lesseps shake in his shoes talk about filling up the River Jordan, appropriating the Dead Sea, and burying the city of Jericho beneath a waste of waters, takes one's breath away. There are people who [illegible] disrespectfully of the equator, but they do not nearly so bad as those who would take such liberties with Palestine. It would not be in the least surprising if petitions were sent up from every Sunday School in the kingdom to save Jericho.

DESTROYING FISH WITH LIME.

At Gloucester Assizes a labourer named Jenkins has been charged with having put a quantity of lime into a stream at Oxenhall, near Newent, with intent to destroy the fish therein. Evidence was given to show that the prisoner was seen in the neighbourhood of the stream with a guano bag, and that afterwards he had a bag containing a quarter of a hundredweight of trout, which he was openly selling. The police-constable who arrested Jenkins deposed that the latter admitted that he "had got them with a lot of chaps." On being charged Jenkins said he was not going to tell any lies about it; they had put the lime in the brook. [illegible] man paid for it. The jury found the prisoner guilty, and the judge, after remarking on the mischievousness of the offence, sentenced him to six months' imprisonment.

A DOG THAT DID NOT UNDERSTAND GAELIC.

A case of an amusing nature has been tried before Sheriff Gillespie at Dunfermline. John Dick, lapper, Dunfermline, sued John [illegible], innkeeper, Milesmark, for the sum of £5, being the value of a collie dog, which pursuer alleged belonged to him. On the 17th ult. the pursuer lost the dog in question, and discovered that it was in defender's possession, who refused to give it up on the ground that it did not belong to the pursuer.—Defender said [illegible] house, but that pursuer, on calling at the house, failed to give a proper description of the dog, and, furthermore, that pursuer had alleged that the dog understood Gaelic, but that when "tested by a competent party, the dog did not know one word of the Gaelic language." In the course of the proceedings pursuer said it was not quite certain that the dog had Gaelic, as he had got a present of it from a Highland farmer, and that it was only in his house a few hours.—Ultimately, defender offered to give over the custody of the dog to pursuer provided the latter paid the cost of advertising and the upkeep of the dog for three weeks. This offer was accepted, and the case was settled conditionally.

A POLICE STRUGGLE ON A RACE COURSE.

At Brighton Police-court on Thursday, Fred. Cotes, George Wright, and Henry [illegible] were charged with committing a robbery with violence on the racecourse on Wednesday. A corn merchant, named Hillman, of Brighton, was seized by the prisoners and another man not in custody, and while one of them held him from behind the others ripped up his coat, which was closely buttoned, and took his watch and chain, valued at £20. The watch was passed to their confederates, and the four men jumped into the enclosure. Bystanders who had seen the robbery, upon calling out for the police, were struck by one of the gang, and when the prisoners were captured the police were roughly set upon by about twenty roughs. A fierce struggle ensued, but the prisoners were secured, and the fourth escaped. A man of the 4th Dragoons, who was called to the aid of the police, struck down three of the gang with his whip. Cotes pleaded guilty to stealing the watch, and was sentenced to six months' imprisonment, and the other two were committed to gaol for two months for the assault. [illegible] was also committed for trial for the robbery.

HURRICANE IN THE PACIFIC.

MANY VESSELS AND LIVES LOST.

According to intelligence received from Australia, dated the early part of July, it seems that the Navigator group of islands has been visited by a terrible hurricane and tidal wave, causing the wreck of many vessels and the loss of several lives. The storm lasted for several hours. Eight vessels were either driven ashore or dashed on to the reef. Many of the native houses suffered very severely, while the wind did much havoc amongst the cocoa nuts and plantations. The European houses escaped with but slight damage. The island of Apia was the greatest sufferer, and it was here the strength of the tidal wave was felt to its fullest extent, as the wave [illegible] everything within its reach. Shortly before the storm commenced a boat left Apia with three men who were on their way to a plantation on an adjacent island. Nothing has been heard of either the occupants or the boat up to the time of the despatch, and it was feared that all had perished. The coffee crops in the group were considerably damaged. The [illegible] priest on the island of Savaii [illegible] death. During the prevalence of the storm he went into the church to save [illegible] vessels. He had forbidden anyone to [illegible] him, and while engaged in his task the [illegible] the building was blown in, killing the unfortunate clergyman, and [illegible] spot.

The yacht Leona, of Greenock, [illegible] master, from Douglas to Campbeltown, was caught in a gale off the Mull of Galloway, and steering for the rocks the crew leaped ashore and she drifted to sea.

A site of eleven acres near to the railway station of Cambridge has been secured for a new cattle market, and the Treasury has approved the purchase. There are [illegible], however, to the scheme, and litigation is threatened.

PUTTING HIM DOWN.—Tomkins (who has been spending his Bank Holiday at Boulogne, to haughty young lady.)—Beg pardon, Miss, but haven't I seen you somewhere across the water? I—Y—You mean—across the counter!—*Funny Folks.*

At a meeting of the North Leicestershire Liberal Association at Loughborough on Thursday evening, Mr. W. [illegible] Fergusson, of Kenyon Hall, [illegible] unanimously chosen as the Liberal candidate for the representation of the division at the next general election.

An extraordinary take of herrings was made by four Papa Westray small boats [illegible] at the whale fishing [illegible] shoal of herrings, and having [illegible] dipped their creels over the side [illegible] and lifted the fish in. The four boats [illegible] in this manner a total of 15 crans.

A WOLF IN SHEEP'S CLOTHING.—[illegible] latest and not the least objectionable [illegible] robbery in Liverpool is for men to dress as women, the latest prisoner being [illegible] beautifully made up with long curls [illegible] as white as notepaper, [illegible] robbing a gentleman of his [illegible] you are talking to a fashionable [illegible] then find yourself in company of a [illegible] garotter, is very objectionable [illegible] put a man off his [illegible] complexion seems to be the [illegible] *fair* about the business.—*Funny Folks.*

A BANK HOLIDAY ROMANCE.—[illegible] Daisy had come up by a cheap excursion [illegible] Worzlebourough to London [illegible] with her as a present a bottle of [illegible] home-made currant wine [illegible] was warm; the wine was [illegible] before taken; and [illegible] from the tunnel a horrible [illegible] Young Spriggins, [illegible] nap, saw Daisy unconscious [illegible] suicide," was his first thought [illegible] the communicator. [illegible] picious: "Suicide! [illegible] drunk again." [illegible] wine is small [illegible] wouldn't believe it, [illegible] and, of course, lived happily ever after.—*Funny Folks.*

Content provided by THE BRITISH LIBRARY BOARD. ALL RIGHTS RESERVED.